

Bedtime Tales

Dilly the Duckling's Soft Quack



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



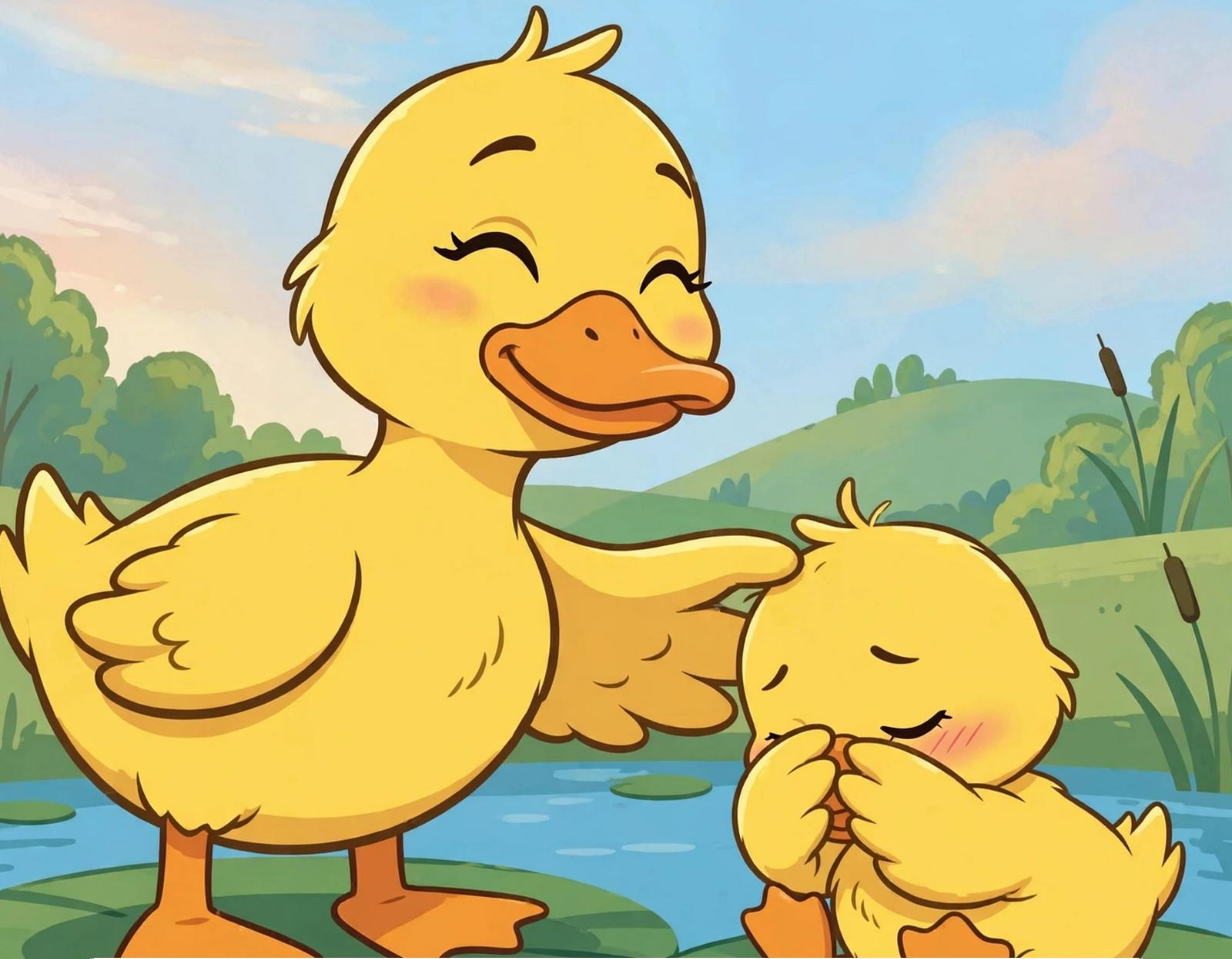
Dilly was the smallest duckling in the pond. Her brothers and sisters quacked very loud — QUACK QUACK QUACK! — at the sunrise and at the dragonflies. But when Dilly tried to quack, only a squeak came out.

"Squeak," said Dilly. She tried again. "Squeak."



Her face felt hot with embarrassment. "I cannot quack like everyone else," she whispered, hiding behind a lily pad. She did not want to try anymore.

Her friend Bram the beaver swam over. He had been building a stick dam when he heard Dilly's tiny squeak. "What a sweet sound!" he said.



Dilly shook her head. "It is too small," she sighed. "It is not a real quack." Big tears wobbled in her eyes.

Bram sat beside her. "Listen to my tail," he said, slapping the water softly. Plip. "Not every sound has to be big," he told her. "A soft quack is still a quack."



"A soft quack is still a quack." Dilly repeated it quietly. "A soft quack is still a quack." It became her brave little saying.

Dilly lifted her beak and let out her small sound. "Squeak quack," she said.



Bram clapped his paws. "Beautiful!" he cheered.



Dilly tried again, a little braver. "Squeak quack! Squeak quack!" The dragonflies danced to her sound, and the tadpoles wiggled with joy. She felt light as a feather — her small quack was special.



Can you make a soft quack like Dilly? Try it: squeak quack!
Now a little louder: squeak quack!



Dilly led a parade around the pond with Bram marching behind her, and her brothers and sisters joined in. They quacked loud, and Dilly quacked soft, and together it sounded like music. QUACK squeak QUACK squeak. Everyone smiled.



When the sun set, Dilly tucked herself under her mother's wing, tired and happy. Bram floated nearby on a log. "Goodnight, sweet quacker," he whispered.



Dilly gave one last tiny quack. "Squeak quack," she yawned. The pond grew quiet and still, and Dilly slept, soft and safe.

**Your own small voice, exactly as it
is, is just right.**

The End

